

SIGNATURE TALENT

### Theo Blackwood, Dealmaker

EXECUTIVE



HIRE  
◆ 5

**SIGNATURE**  
Signature: one copy per deck.

**Commit** this employee to **poach** an opponent's employee. (Pay its Hire plus 2 Surplus. It gains Non-compete and arrives committed.)

Has never met an executive he didn't try to hire, usually at dinner, usually from your table.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 208 / 379

OFFICE LOCATION

### Grand Bahama

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN  
◆ 3 branch only

**Regulation**

**Headquarters** or **Open** as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Assumed Reinsurance funding sources you control, rounded down.

The treaties cross oceans with the paperwork already in order.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 362 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 run start

**STAPLE**  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If **uncommitted** at the start of your turn, gain its **Margin** before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 run start

**STAPLE**  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If **uncommitted** at the start of your turn, gain its **Margin** before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 run start

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Staple: any number per deck.

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Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 run start

**STAPLE**  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If **uncommitted** at the start of your turn, gain its **Margin** before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Term Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 run start

**STAPLE**  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If **uncommitted** at the start of your turn, gain its **Margin** before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 003 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Term Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 run start

**STAPLE**  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If **uncommitted** at the start of your turn, gain its **Margin** before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 003 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Term Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 run start

**STAPLE**  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If **uncommitted** at the start of your turn, gain its **Margin** before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 003 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 379

STABLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 379

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID

COST

3

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 054 / 379

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID

COST

3

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

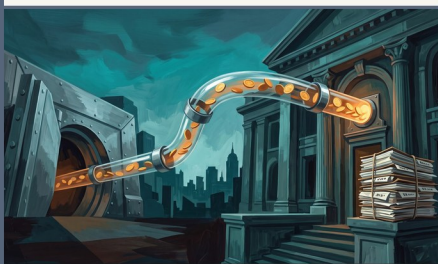
A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 054 / 379

## Litigation Finance

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation ▼ Litigation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Whenever a Litigation Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

When claims severity rises, someone funds the lawsuit.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 066 / 379

## Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Credit ▼ Rising Interest Rates

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Dash for Cash, Northern Rock Bank Run, or Great Depression hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 073 / 379

## Short Sale

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 127 / 379

## Industry Lobbying

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Regulation Stress Test that hits you.

The trade association would like to submit four hundred pages of comments.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 130 / 379

## Exclusion Clause

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's largest clause.

Please see page 47, paragraph (c)(ii), which your customer did not read.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 133 / 379

## Too Big to Fail

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

If you become insolvent, every other company loses 5 Surplus. If all remaining players become insolvent because of this, you win the game.

What regulators call interconnectedness, your rivals call a hostage situation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 141 / 379

## Corporate Jet

TRAVEL



PRICE

◆ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

You may make an additional talent move (hire or open an office) each turn.

Destroyed if a Reputation Stress Test hits you.

Strictly for business travel, which this quarter takes place in Aspen.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 368 / 379

## Chief Financial Officer

EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 4

Once each turn, you may turn up to 3 Leverage into Surplus, one for one.

Turns leverage into capital and capital into a slide for the board.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 199 / 379

## Treasurer

RISK &amp; COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 2

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity clauses.

Knows where every dollar is at 4 p.m., and where it has to be by 9 a.m.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 209 / 379

## Compliance Patsy

RISK &amp; COMPLIANCE

DARK



HIRE

◆ 1

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

**Commit** this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 5 of your loss from its Regulation or Litigation clauses. Then fire this employee.

*Signed everything, read nothing, and is available to start immediately.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 217 / 379

## Margin Call

LIQUIDITY



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

*The broker would like a word, and also your cash.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 279 / 379

## Nuclear Verdict

LITIGATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Litigation

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Litigation exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 2 more.

*The jury took forty minutes to reach a verdict that will take four years to appeal.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 274 / 379

## Consent Decree

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile and 2 per Dark card on their board, plus 4 more. Then they have one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

*No admission of wrongdoing, just a very large check and a new board.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 303 / 379

## Short and Distort

REPUTATION

DARK



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per investment they control, plus 6 more.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Blockchain Co. it controls.

*Step one: short the stock. Step two: post the rumor. There is no step three.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 299 / 379

## Executive Scandal

REPUTATION



COST

◆ 5

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on their board and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 6 more. Then they have one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

*Leaked texts, a 6 a.m. board call, and a very generous severance.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 284 / 379

## Creditor-on-Creditor Violence Liability Management Exercise

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Credit

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 3 Surplus per Credit exposure and 3 per investment they control.

*The new lenders get the collateral, while the old lenders get a letter explaining what an unrestricted subsidiary is.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 312 / 379

## Rated Feeder Note

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

SIGNATURE ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Basel III Endgame or Solvency II hits you.

*The same private loans, sliced so the capital charge drops from thirty percent to four.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 087 / 379

## Funding Agreement Notes

ANNUITY · FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Liquidity

Signature: one copy per deck.

*Sold like a bond, rated like a policy, spent like a lending fund.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 043 / 379

## Assumed Reinsurance

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY



1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST



1

each turn

▲ Nat Cat: Any

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

*Insurance for insurance companies, because it's insurers all the way down.*

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 027 / 379

## Assumed Reinsurance

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY



1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST



1

each turn

▲ Nat Cat: Any

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

*Insurance for insurance companies, because it's insurers all the way down.*

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 027 / 379

## Des Moines

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN



3

branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.

At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

*Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 360 / 379

## Emergency Equity Infusion

RESPONSE



COST



2

SIGNATURE RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Gain 10 Surplus.

Then, if you control 2 or more cards Northern Rock Bank Run would hit and a Northern Rock Bank Run is in the Stress Test pile, it comes off the pile at once and hits every company.

*Announce an emergency raise, and everyone learns there's an emergency.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 149 / 379

## Noncompete Injunction

LITIGATION



COST



2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

*The judge agreed that the agreement was enforceable, and that the new job started in eighteen months.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 340 / 379

## License Suspension

REGULATION



COST



3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one funding source to discard, chosen by the runner.

*The letter was two paragraphs long, and the second paragraph was the one about ceasing to write new business.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 337 / 379

## Cancer Cured

LONGEVITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Longevity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Longevity exposure.

*Champagne in the lab, followed by a very quiet meeting in annuity reserving.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 250 / 379

## Affordable Care Act

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

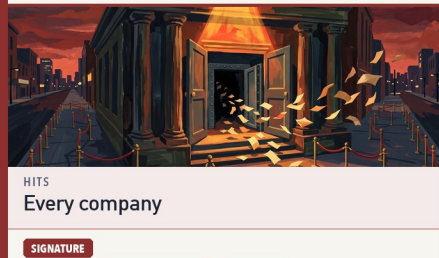
*In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 253 / 379

## Northern Rock Bank Run

LIQUIDITY - AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure. Then each company discards half its Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds, Private Credit Fund, or Feeder Fund it controls.

*In September 2007, Northern Rock sought emergency support as wholesale funding dried up. Depositors queued outside its branches.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 272 / 379

## Basel III Endgame

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2023



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure, plus 5 more. Then each company discards a card.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

In July 2023, U.S. regulators proposed the Basel III endgame, which would have raised big banks' capital requirements by about 16%.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 278 / 379

## Chainsaw AI at Sunbeam

CORPORATE · AS-IF REPLAY, 1996



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus. Then each company fires each of its employees with Hire 3 or less.

In 1996, Sunbeam hired AI Dunlap, known as Chainsaw AI, who cut half its workforce; the profits that followed later had to be restated.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 283 / 379

## Morris Worm

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 1988



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber ▲ Short-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Cyber exposure and 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure. Then each company discards a card.

In November 1988, a graduate student's self-copying program ran out of control and crashed about a tenth of the computers on the internet. The internet was smaller then.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 263 / 379

## Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 287 / 379

## 1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Rising Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure.

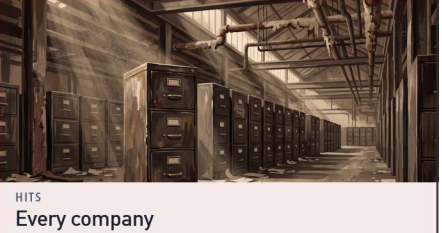
In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 265 / 379

## Asbestos Claims

LITIGATION



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD DEVELOPING EVENT

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: all stages this round, each with a response window.

**Stage 1.** Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

**Stage 2.** Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

**Stage 3.** Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

The exposure was decades old, and the claims kept coming for decades more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 295 / 379

## AI Bubble Bursts

MARKET



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every AI card and every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

It was three laptops in a trench coat the whole time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 379

## Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 290 / 379

## 2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 237 / 379

# AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE  
▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.  
Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.  
On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

# Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD  
▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.  
Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.  
On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

# Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE  
▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.  
Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.  
In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

# Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE  
▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.  
Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.  
In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.